disappointed America and competitors have cheated it. India is fortunate in being neither.

The Indo-American relationship is obviously at the heart of the overall approach to the West. In its early stages, the British had a disproportionate role in crafting the larger policy. As a result, a lot of the post-Partition considerations have been carried over into foreign policy positions. Over time, however, American interests acquired a more autonomous basis that coincided with the overlaps created by India's own growing equities to the East. Even today, the differential between the convergences East and West of India are visible. How much they would diminish will reflect the larger Western closeness to India.

As the Goldilocks period with the US came to an end, efforts to expand ties yielded results. The breadth of contacts and the ease of conversations now would not have been imaginable a decade and half ago. The strength of the relationship can veritably be measured in G2G, B2B, P2P or even T2T (technology to technology) terms. A country that did not buy any military equipment for four decades operates multiple platforms now. Societal contact has been especially strong, underpinned by the large presence of Indian students. Public sentiment in both nations is very positive and the Indian diaspora has become an extraordinary bridge that has impacted the US Congress in particular.

While this relationship has undoubtedly been the transformational story of our generation, it is not without its challenges. This is inbuilt into the nature of international relations, some from diverging geopolitical perspectives and others from domestic compulsions. Currently, frictions on trade and concerns on mobility require the greatest attention. But beyond that, there is a larger issue of continuously tending to the relationship. India has to maintain a narrative in the US of its value, whether it is in terms of geopolitics, shared challenges, market attractions, technology strengths or burden-sharing. And it must be customized for the President of the day. Given the discontinuity in American policy, it is also important that their engagement continuously factors in the updated priorities and the issues that emerge from them.